

Relatório Semanal - Lok Sabha

04/08/2025 a 10/08/2025

Resumo semanal das questions & answers da Lok Sabha ao Ministério de Relações Exteriores da Índia.

Lok Sabha Questions & Answers - Weekly Summary

Friday, 08 August 2025

QUESTION NO - 292 RELATION WITH WEST ASIAN COUNTRIES

— Lok Sabha Question 292 inquired about the impact of recent geopolitical events, including the Russia-Ukraine war and West Asian conflicts, on India's diplomatic and economic relations. The Minister of External Affairs, Dr. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, responded that the government "constantly monitors all geopolitical developments" and acts to safeguard India's interests through diplomacy and dialogue. The government prioritizes energy security, employing a multi-pronged strategy including diversification of sources and domestic production increases. Finally, the government affirmed its commitment to the safety of Indian nationals abroad, utilizing various methods including advisories and evacuations when necessary.

QUESTION NO - †*299 DIPLOMATIC ENGAGEMENT DURING OPERATION SINDOOR

— The Lok Sabha Question 299 inquired about India's diplomatic engagement ("Operation Sindoor") following a terrorist attack. The Minister of External Affairs, Dr. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, responded that seven all-party delegations visited 33 countries to highlight Pakistan's role in terrorism and India's counter-terrorism efforts. These delegations, comprising MPs and experts, engaged with various stakeholders, resulting in increased international condemnation of Pakistan and the listing of the terrorist group "The Resistance Front" (TRF) by the UNSC and the USA as an FTO/SDGT. The government stated it will continue its international engagement on counter-terrorism cooperation.

QUESTION NO - *295 INTERNSHIP PROGRAMME BY MEA

— Lok Sabha Member Shri K.E. Prakash inquired about the Ministry of External Affairs' (MEA) internship program, specifically its accessibility, outreach, and partnerships with educational institutions, particularly focusing on Tamil Nadu. The Minister of External Affairs, Dr. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, responded that the program uses an online application process ("<https://internship.mea.gov.in>") emphasizing merit and regional representation, and that no formal partnerships with educational institutions or district authorities are currently in place. Data provided shows the district-wise distribution of interns selected from Tamil Nadu since the program's inception, with Chennai having the highest number (5). No specific measures to improve awareness in rural areas were detailed.

QUESTION NO - 3447 TERRITORIES OCCUPIED BY CHINA IN 1962

— Lok Sabha Question No. 3447 addressed the territories occupied by China since the 1962 Sino-Indian War. The government stated that China illegally occupies approximately "38,000 sq. kms. of Indian territory." Since 1962, India and China have engaged in extensive diplomatic efforts, including eight rounds of formal border negotiations (1981-1987), fifteen rounds of Joint Working Group meetings (1989-2005), and numerous Special Representatives talks (2003-2024), culminating in the "Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for Settlement of India-China Boundary Question" in 2005 and a "Common Understanding" in 2012. Despite these efforts, a final boundary settlement remains elusive.

QUESTION NO- † 3428 INDIA-MALDIVES VISION DOCUMENT

— Lok Sabha Question No. 3428 inquired about the contribution of the second India-Maldives High Level Core Group (HLCG) meeting to the "India-Maldives Vision Document on Comprehensive Economic and Maritime

Security Partnership," and the specific areas of cooperation discussed. The Minister of State for External Affairs responded that the HLCG, meeting twice in 2025 (January and May), oversaw progress on the Joint Vision. Discussions covered a broad range of areas including "political exchanges, development partnership, trade, finance, energy, digital, health, defence and security, capacity building and training, people-to-people linkages and cooperation at regional and multilateral fora." The Minister concluded that the meetings were "helpful in advancing India-Maldives cooperation."

QUESTION NO- 3423 INDIA'S STANDS ON THE PALESTINE

— Lok Sabha Question No. 3423 inquired about India's assistance to Palestine and its stance on the Gaza crisis. The Minister of State for External Affairs responded that India supports a "negotiated two-State solution" and Palestine's UN membership, while condemning both the October 2023 terror attacks on Israel and civilian casualties in the conflict. India has provided approximately 70 MT of humanitarian aid since the conflict began, including medicines, and has committed USD 26 million in projects over the last five years, plus USD 27.5 million to UNRWA since 2020-21. India's diplomatic position emphasizes a ceasefire, hostage release, and a peaceful resolution through dialogue and diplomacy.

QUESTION NO- 3416 PROJECT TIED ASSISTANCE

— Lok Sabha Question No. 3416 inquired about India's "Project Tied Assistance" program with Bhutan, specifically concerning ten new projects and financial aid for Bhutan's Economic Stimulus Programme (ESP). The Minister of State for External Affairs responded that India has committed INR 10,000 crore for Bhutan's 13th Five Year Plan (2024-2029), including recently approved projects totaling INR 1113 crore in various sectors. The government has already disbursed INR 750 crore for the ESP and INR 100 crore as a Programme Grant. The Royal Government of Bhutan expressed gratitude for this support, stating it will boost the economy and create opportunities for Bhutanese youth.

QUESTION NO- 3411 DATABASE FOR INDIAN MIGRANT WORKERS

— The Lok Sabha question inquired about the existence of a state-wise database for Indian migrant workers abroad, specifically focusing on Telangana, and the government's mechanisms for addressing their issues. The Minister of External Affairs responded that the government maintains data on ECR passport holders via the "e-Migrate" portal, providing Annexures with State-wise and gender-wise data for Telangana (for the period January 2020 to June 2025). The government highlighted its commitment to the safety and well-being of Indian workers abroad, citing various grievance redressal mechanisms including the "Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendra" and the use of the "Indian Community Welfare Fund (ICWF)" for assistance. Additional safeguards for female domestic workers, such as age restrictions and the use of state-run recruiting agencies, were also mentioned.

QUESTION NO- 3406 DIPLOMATIC TIES WITH NEIGHBOURING COUNTRIES

— This Lok Sabha question inquired about India's initiatives to strengthen diplomatic ties with neighboring and strategic partner countries. The Minister of State for External Affairs responded that India pursues "multifaceted partnerships" focusing on political ties, economic growth, security, and the "Neighbourhood First Policy" and "MAHASAGAR" outlook. The government cited high-level visits and bilateral agreements as key methods for achieving these goals, details of which are provided in annexures. Finally, the response detailed measures taken to protect Indian citizens abroad, including 24/7 emergency numbers, online grievance portals, and bilateral agreements with Gulf countries to address worker welfare concerns.

QUESTION NO- 3403 RESTARTING OF LALMONIRHAT AIRBASE IN BANGLADESH

— A Lok Sabha question inquired about Bangladesh potentially authorizing China to restart operations at the Lalmonirhat airbase, raising Indian security concerns due to the shared border. The Minister of State for External Affairs responded that the Indian government has "noted reports" regarding the airbase and a Bangladeshi military press briefing stating "there are no plans at present for the Lalmonirhat airfield to be used for military purposes." India, the response continued, "continues to monitor all developments having a bearing on national security and takes all necessary measures to safeguard it." No specific objections lodged with Bangladesh were detailed in the answer.